

BACKUP AND RECOVERY GUIDE

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Prepared By: Omondi Mbara

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1. Introduction

Data is one of the most valuable assets in any organization or personal project. Losing important files due to accidental deletion, hardware failure, malware, theft, or natural disasters can result in

significant setbacks. A reliable backup and recovery plan ensures that important documents remain available and can be restored whenever necessary.

For the **Professional Digital Filing System**, backup and recovery procedures are essential to protect all project documentation, reports, procedures, guides, templates, presentations, screenshots, and supporting files.

2. Purpose

This guide provides standardized procedures for backing up, protecting, and recovering files within the Professional Digital Filing System. It ensures that project information remains secure, accessible, and recoverable in the event of data loss or system failure.

3. What is Backup and Recovery?

Backup is the process of creating copies of digital files and storing them in separate locations to prevent permanent data loss.

Recovery is the process of restoring backed-up files after they have been lost, damaged, deleted, or corrupted.

A complete backup and recovery strategy helps ensure business continuity and protects valuable project information.

4. Importance of Backup and Recovery

Implementing a backup and recovery plan provides several benefits, including:

- Protection against accidental deletion.
- Recovery from hardware failure.
- Protection from ransomware and malware.
- Prevention of permanent data loss.
- Support for business continuity.
- Improved document security.
- Easier file restoration.
- Compliance with document management best practices.

5. Types of Backups

Several backup methods can be used depending on project requirements.

Full Backup

A Full Backup creates a complete copy of all project files.

Advantages:

- Easy recovery.
- Complete data protection.
- Simplified restoration process.

Disadvantages:

- Requires more storage space.
 - Takes longer to complete.
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Incremental Backup

An Incremental Backup stores only files that have changed since the last backup.

Advantages:

- Faster backup process.
- Requires less storage.
- Efficient for frequent backups.

Disadvantages:

- Recovery may require multiple backup versions.
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Differential Backup

A Differential Backup saves all files changed since the last Full Backup.

Advantages:

- Faster recovery than incremental backups.
- Moderate storage requirements.

Disadvantages:

- Backup size increases over time until the next Full Backup.
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6. Backup Strategy

The Professional Digital Filing System should follow the **3-2-1 Backup Rule**.

Maintain:

- Three copies of important files.
- Two different storage media.
- One off-site or cloud backup.

Recommended backup locations include:

- Primary computer.
 - External hard drive.
 - USB flash drive.
 - Cloud storage service.
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7. Backup Schedule

The following backup schedule is recommended.

Backup Type	Frequency
Full Backup	Weekly
Incremental Backup	Daily
Cloud Synchronization	Continuous or Daily
External Drive Backup	Weekly
Recovery Test	Monthly

Perform additional backups before making major project updates.

8. Backup Storage Locations

Store backup copies in separate secure locations.

Recommended storage locations include:

- Computer hard drive.
- External hard drive.
- USB flash drive.
- Cloud storage (Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox).
- Network storage device (if available).

Avoid storing all backups in a single location.

9. Backup Procedure

Follow these steps to create a backup.

1. Close all open project files.
2. Verify that documents are complete.
3. Save the latest versions.
4. Copy the project folder to the backup location.
5. Verify that all files have copied successfully.
6. Label the backup with the current date.
7. Store the backup securely.
8. Record the backup activity if maintaining a backup log.

Example backup folder name:

Professional-Digital-Filing-System_Backup_2026-07-05

10. Recovery Procedure

If project files are lost or damaged:

1. Identify the missing or corrupted files.
2. Locate the most recent backup.
3. Verify backup integrity.
4. Copy the required files to the original project folder.

5. Confirm that all files open correctly.
6. Verify folder organization.
7. Resume normal work.
8. Document the recovery if required.

Always recover from the most recent verified backup.

11. Testing Backup Integrity

Regularly test backups to ensure they can be restored successfully.

Testing should include:

- Opening PDF files.
- Opening Microsoft Word documents.
- Verifying folder structure.
- Checking screenshots.
- Confirming file completeness.
- Ensuring documents are not corrupted.

Conduct recovery testing at least once every month.

12. Security Considerations

Protect backup files by:

- Using strong passwords where appropriate.
- Encrypting sensitive backup media.
- Restricting unauthorized access.
- Keeping backup drives in secure locations.
- Regularly updating antivirus software.
- Avoiding public computers for backup storage.
- Removing obsolete backup copies securely.

Security is essential to maintaining the confidentiality and integrity of project files.

13. Best Practices

Follow these recommendations:

- Perform backups regularly.
 - Verify backups after completion.
 - Store backups in multiple locations.
 - Maintain consistent folder structures.
 - Use descriptive backup names.
 - Keep backup media secure.
 - Test recovery procedures regularly.
 - Remove outdated backups according to your retention policy.
 - Maintain both editable and PDF versions of documents.
 - Update backups after major project changes.
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14. Common Mistakes to Avoid

Avoid:

- Never creating backups.
 - Keeping only one copy of important files.
 - Forgetting to verify backup completion.
 - Storing all backups on one device.
 - Ignoring recovery testing.
 - Using unclear backup names.
 - Leaving backup drives unsecured.
 - Failing to update backup copies.
 - Backing up incomplete project files.
 - Overwriting good backups without verification.
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15. Related Documents

- User Guide
- Digital Filing System Folder Structure Guide
- File Naming Convention Guide
- Digital Filing Best Practices Guide
- Document Management Guide
- GitHub Repository Guide
- File Backup and Recovery Procedure
- Archive Management Procedure
- Duplicate File Management Procedure
- Project Report

16. Conclusion

A well-designed backup and recovery strategy is a critical component of an effective Professional Digital Filing System. Regular backups, secure storage, and periodic recovery testing ensure that valuable project documentation remains protected against accidental loss, hardware failure, malware, and other unforeseen events.

By following this guide, users can confidently safeguard their digital files, minimize downtime, and maintain the integrity, availability, and continuity of their documentation throughout the lifecycle of the Professional Digital Filing System.